Whispering Tomasz's name seemed to soothe her.

As they waited for the thermometer, Josef felt Maria's wrist for a pulse.

"I was worried that she hadn't eaten all day," Léa said. "Polish rations are less than ours."

"Only three hundred grams of bread a day. Watered-down soup. Meat only on Sundays." He shook his head. "They cannot be expected to work fourteen-hour shifts on starvation rations."

"That's why I went to the canteen to get some coffee cake that she could put in her bag and eat later. When I came back, she had her head on the desk."

He placed a stethoscope on Maria's chest and hunched over her, listening. In the windowless room, patients coughed and called out. Josef ignored them, giving all his attention to Maria.

"No fluid in the lungs. That's a good sign." He removed the thermometer. "Forty degrees. It's concerning but not yet dangerous. Would you mind going to my office and running one of the towels near the sink under cold water, rinsing it out, then bringing it back and putting it on her forehead to lower the temperature while I examine her further?"

Léa did as he asked, quickly returning. She placed the damp cloth on Maria's forehead.

"I want to examine her stomach, see if there's swelling." He undid the buttons on Maria's shirt dress. Despite the warm weather, she wore an extra layer, and he pulled it aside until he finally uncovered skin. Then he stopped.

"Léa?"

"Yes?"

"Come here," he said, pointing at the small swell of Maria's belly. Léa gave a slight gasp, raising a hand to her mouth. He quickly covered her stomach with her clothing, then his brown eyes locked on Léa's. "May we speak in private?"

She nodded and followed him to his office, sitting on the chair where she typed his patient reports at night. He gently closed the door behind her and leaned against the table, crossing his legs and placing his hands on his hips.

"Was Maria the one who had conjunctivitis?"

"Yes."